

OPTIMISING DONATIONS FOR GLOBAL IMPACT

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Executive Summary

The transformative power of data in the mission to drive global health initiatives has led ReachOut Worldwide (ROWW) to explore new horizons in data analytics. This report presents an advanced analysis of ROW's donation data, with the goal of further understanding the performance of the organization and its donor base. Throughout the analysis, four key areas are addressed including comprehensive review of giving performance, detailed segmentation of the donor base, individual analysis of donors, and evaluation of the various appeals used by the organization.

Each of these areas is explored through a combination of segmentation techniques, trend analysis, projections, and impact assessments. Advanced data visualization tools, such as Tableau, have been used to create interactive dashboards that allow detailed exploration of the data and identification of key insights.

The report's ultimate purpose is to provide ROW senior management with strategic insight to optimize their fundraising efforts and maximize their impact on global health initiatives. The recommendations derived from this analysis are based on solid data and offer a strategic approach to achieving organizational objectives in an ever-changing competitive environment.

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1. Background

In an increasingly interconnected and dynamic world, charities and not-for-profit organizations face unprecedented challenges as they seek support and funding for their important initiatives. In this context, ReachOut Worldwide (ROW) stands out as a leading organization committed to improving global health and access to healthcare in underserved communities around the world. Recognizing the critical importance of innovation and data analysis to its mission, ROW has collaborated closely with specialized consultants to harness the potential of its donation data and optimize its fundraising efforts.

This report dives into ROW's vast ocean of giving data, spanning a five-year period from 2019 to 2023. The goal is to provide a detailed and meaningful view of ROW's performance and the dynamics of its donor base. By closely examining this data, we seek to identify hidden trends, patterns and opportunities that can guide future strategies and maximize the impact of ROW's global health initiatives.

Finally, this report aims to provide ROW senior management with a strategic roadmap based on solid insights and concrete actions derived from the exhaustive analysis of donation data. By better understanding past performance, emerging trends and future opportunities, ROW will be better equipped to make informed decisions and optimize its fundraising strategies. The result will be a more efficient, effective, and mission-driven organization, able to maximize its impact on improving global health and access to healthcare in underserved communities worldwide.

2. An in-depth Review of ROW's Overall Donation Performance

2.1. Donors Location Performance Analysis

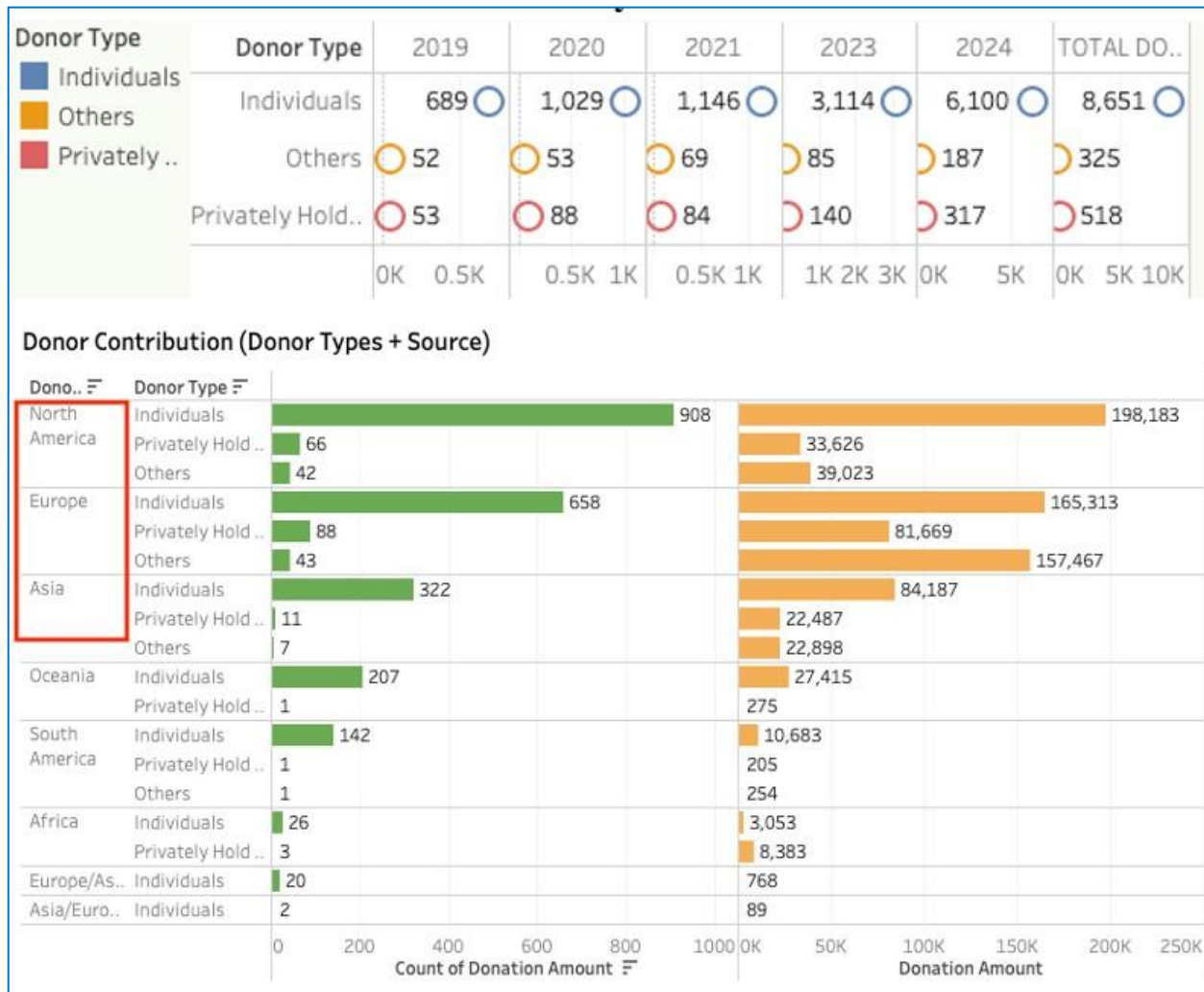


Figure 1: Donors Location Performance Analysis

This overview summarizes the analysis of donor data by continent, highlighting key trends and strategic insights. North America, Europe, and Asia are the top contributors in terms of donation volumes and amounts. The USA is the primary contributor in North America, with individual donors dominating the landscape, indicating a strong culture of personal philanthropy (WFP United Nations, 2023). In Europe, the UK leads in donations, followed by Liechtenstein, France, and Luxembourg, with significant contributions from privately held companies and other sources, suggesting a diverse and robust donor base. In such

locations, segmenting donors based on behavior and tailoring communication strategies to different donor types (individuals and companies) can enhance donor engagement and retention. Donations from Asia are also substantial, with notable contributions from countries like China and Singapore, indicating growing philanthropic engagement in the region. The disparities among countries in donation patterns are influenced by economic factors such as GDP per capita and cultural attitudes towards giving, underscoring the complexity of these global variations (Einolf, 2020). To improve donation performance, researching tax benefits for charitable donations in key countries and incorporating this information into targeted marketing materials can emphasize the financial advantages of donating.

2.2. Donation Source Performance Drill Down Analysis

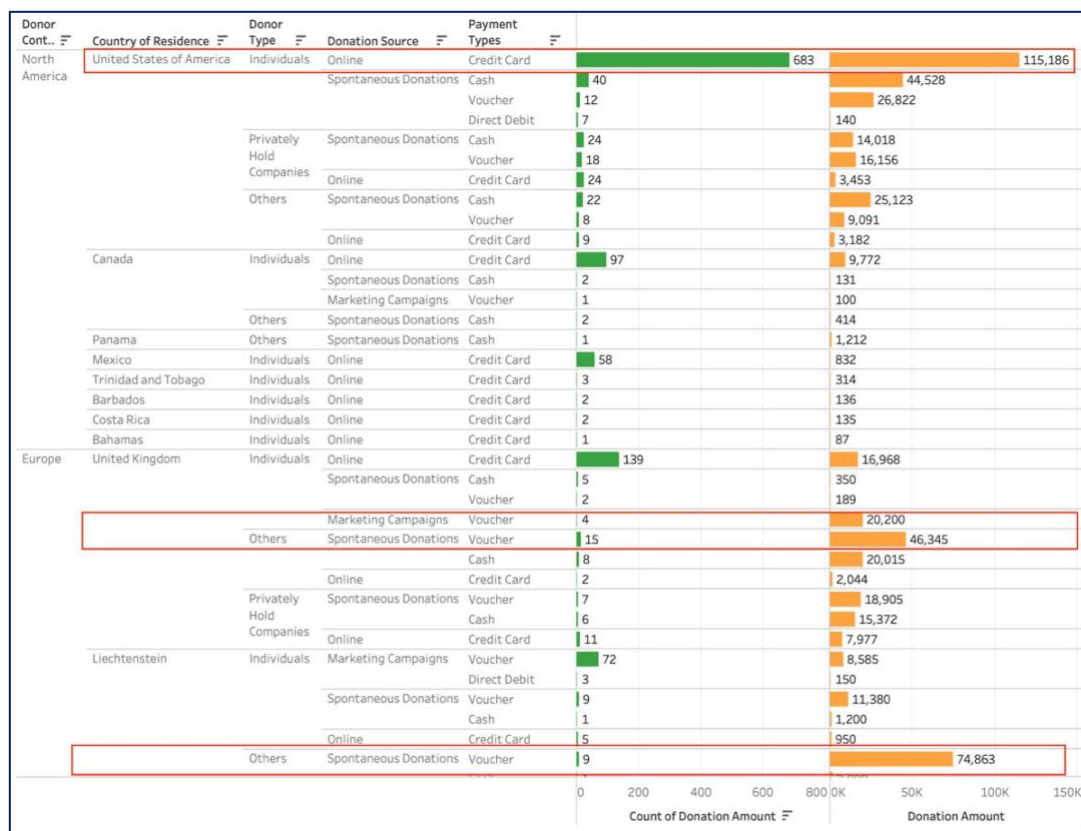


Figure 2: Donation Source Performance Drill Down Analysis

The performance drill-down analysis reveals that the USA shows a strong preference for online donations, with individuals predominantly using credit cards. Enhancing online

donation platforms to be user-friendly and secure (Victoria, Tato-Jimé, Chapleo, & Sepulcri , 2023), especially for the US market, will streamline the donation process and cater to the preference for credit card payments. In the UK, marketing campaigns and spontaneous donations, particularly via vouchers, are highly effective. To replicate this success in regions with lower donations, analyzing and adapting successful UK marketing strategies for other regions (Jonsson & Foss, 2011) can increase future engagement and donations.

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2.3. Appeal Performance and Drill Down Analysis by Donation Source

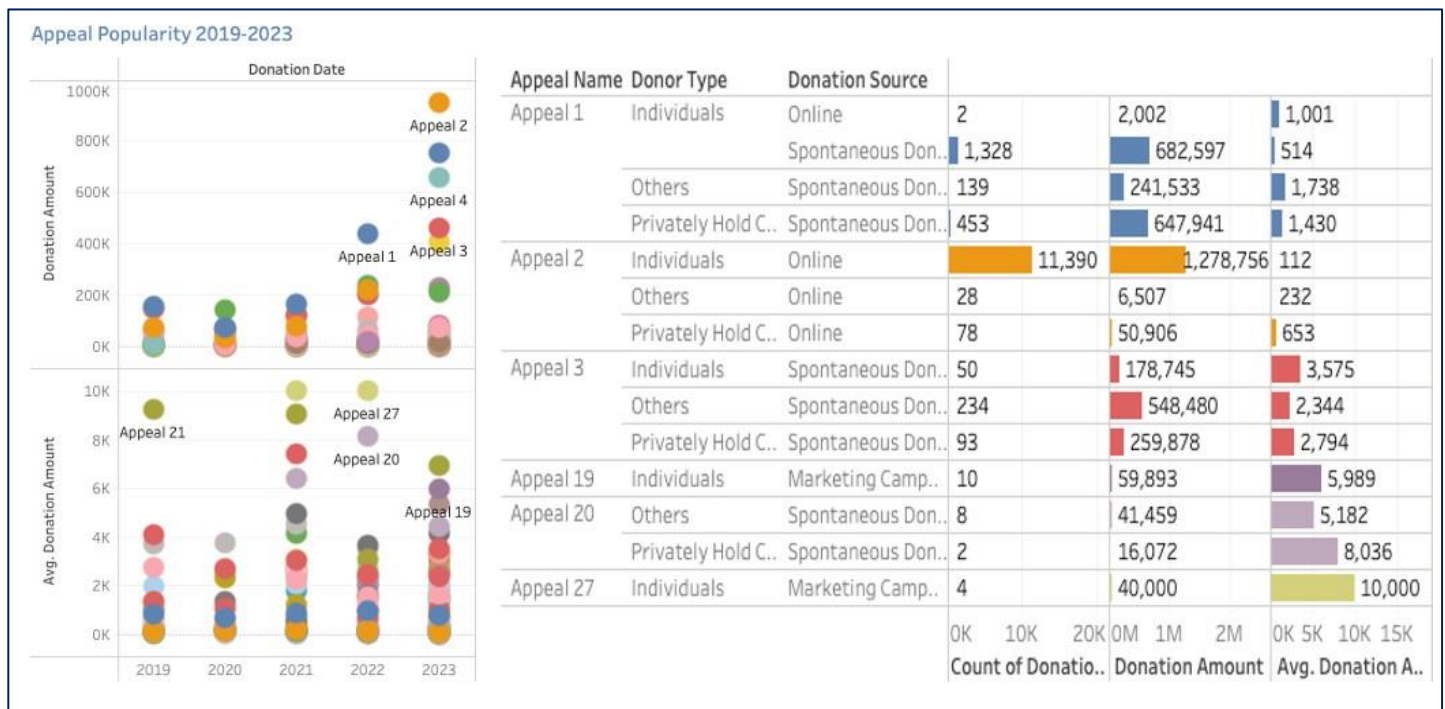


Figure 3: Appeal Performance and Drill Down Analysis by Donation Source

Analyzing appeal popularity looking into the total donation amount as well as average donation amount over the years provides a balanced approach and some key insights. Appeals supported by both individuals and privately held companies, such as Appeals 1 and 2, indicate effective resource allocation, while appeals with high average donation amounts, like Appeals 3 and 27, highlight the presence of major donors. To leverage these insights, ROW should consider several strategic actions. First, focusing on appeals that receive support from both individuals and companies and exploring new opportunities for similar mixed support will ensure sustainable funding. Finally, identifying major donors from high value appeals and developing recognition programs (Samek & Sheremeta, 2023) will maintain and strengthen relationships, ensuring continued and increased contributions.

3. In-depth review on the Donor base

3.1. Donor Segmentation Analysis

To draw out the percentage of “*high-value*” donors with most potential to RoW, it is essential to understand and effectively segment the donor base. This assists in optimising engagement strategies and maximizing contributions from the high value donors. According to a 2021 research study looking to develop models that forecast the giving patterns of donors, finding out the special characteristics that increase a donor's likelihood of donating and spotting these patterns in demographics or donating history is crucial (Eiland et al., 2021). By devising factors for individual donors such as the average amount of donation (Monetary), number of donations (Frequency), and their latest donation (Recency) donors can be ranked based on their interest in ROW and the current appeals. This Recency, Frequency and Monetary (RFM Model) allows for us to view the ranking of each donor by their value. In the case of ROW, as seen in Appendix A, each donor receives a rank from 1 to 5 (5 being the largest) and based on this they are categorised into the following donor segments in Figure 4.

Segmenting Donors based on RFM

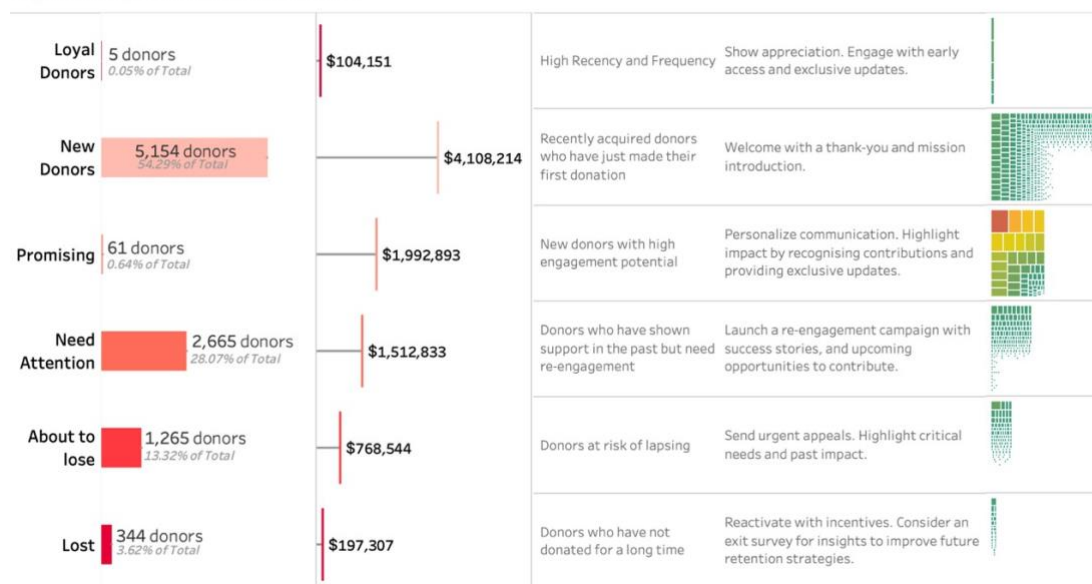


Figure 4: RFM based Donor Segmentationⁱ

To tailor strategies and address the unique characteristics and needs of each donor group, the senior management team at ROW should consider:

Loyal Donors

Criteria: High Recency and Frequency, significant monetary contributions.

Size: 5 donors (0.05% of total).

Loyal donors are critical to ROW's cash flow. Beyond basic recognition, research by Sargeant and Shang (2011) highlights the importance of personalised engagement and stewardship programs to loyal donors to show continued appreciation. ROW's senior management team could consider implementing a loyalty program offering exclusive content, personalised impact reports for Donor's PR team, and opportunities to engage with the audience. Regular feedback loops through surveys can also enhance their sense of involvement and value.

New Donors

Criteria: Recently acquired donors who have made their first donation.

Size: 5,154 donors (54.29% of total).

Accounting for more than half of the current donor base, these new donors have a high recency score but low monetary and frequency score. To convert them to repeat donors, ROW can adopt a multichannel communication strategy that integrates the appeals they have donated to in the most profound manner and potentially in conjunction with other relevant appeals. Martin et al (2023) suggest that behavior framing is a successful way to convert new customers (in this case donors) to join the wagon. Combining email updates, social media interactions, and personalized messages can also help build a strong initial relationship. Introducing a donor welcome series that targets and engages new donors about ROW's mission and impact is also crucial.

Promising Donors

Criteria: New donors with high engagement potential.

Size: 61 donors (0.64% of total).

These donors have indicated strong contributions and high interest in the ROW by donating higher amounts. By fostering this interaction, ROW reduces the need for customer acquisition and can create long-term supporters who will provide a steady stream of revenue which is the ideal goal. Through highlighting the impact of donations, using peer-to-peer fundraising, and offering opportunities for these donors to join exclusive groups or events, Bekkers and Wiepking (2011) suggest that engagement can be enhanced.

Donors Needing Attention

Criteria: Donors who have shown support in the past but need re-engagement.

Size: 2,665 donors (28.07% of total).

New donor acquisition can be costly as it requires more time to analyse. By re-engaging lapsed donors, ROW can use existing data to target specific donors. For this, ROW must understand reasons for disengagement to re-allocate resources efficiently. Sargeant and Woodliffe (2008) found that personalised re-engagement campaigns that address specific reasons for lapsing are highly effective. ROW should consider conducting surveys or focus groups to gather insights and tailor re-engagement messages accordingly. Highlighting past impacts and future needs can rekindle their interest.

Donors About to Be Lost

Criteria: Donors at risk of lapsing, showing a decline in engagement and donation frequency.

Size: 1,265 donors (13.32% of total).

Preventing donor attrition involves timely and urgent interventions. As per Waters (2011), conveying the sense of urgency and displaying the instantaneous consequences of contributions might lead to churning engaging. To make ongoing donating easier, ROW

should issue tailored appeals, that have worked in the past that highlight urgent needs and include opportunities for recurring donations.

Lost Donors

Criteria: Donors who have not donated for a long time.

Size: 344 donors (3.62% of total).

ROW's senior management team can conduct reactivation efforts that blend emotional appeals with incentives to win back lost donors. According to research by Larson and McClellan (2017), emphasising the benefits of prior contributions and reestablishing connections through personal tales can be successful strategies. Return donations can also be encouraged by providing possibilities for matching gifts or hosting unique re-engagement activities.

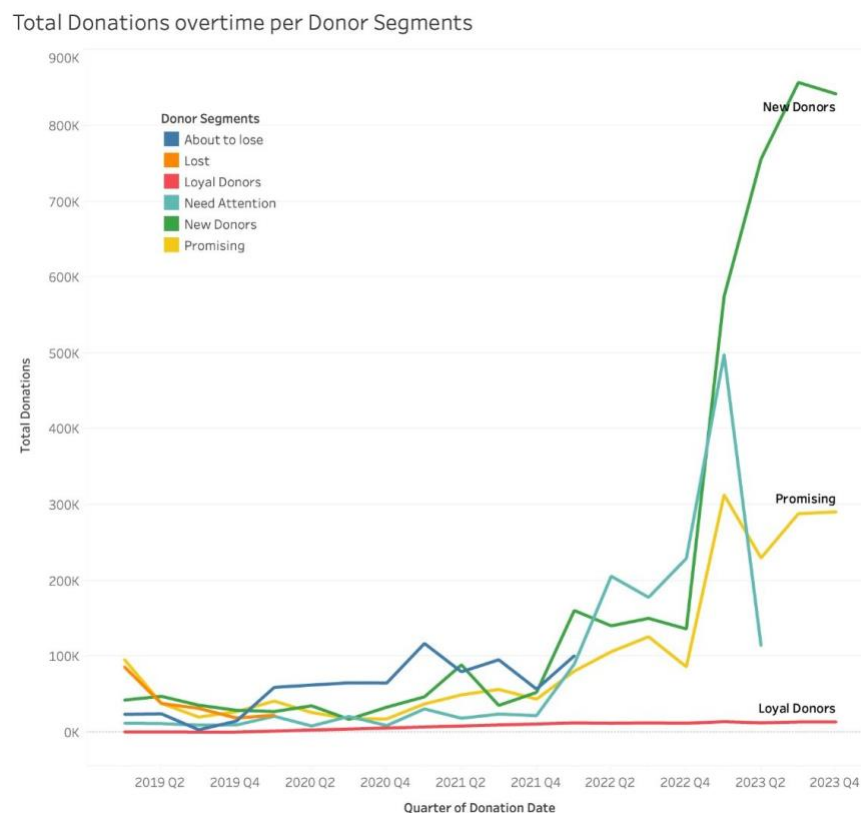


Figure 5: Total Donations Overtime based Donor Segments

Similarly, as seen in Figure 5, New donors show a dramatic increase, peaking at over \$800,000 in recent quarters, indicating significant acquisition success. Promising donors also exhibit a notable upward trend, suggesting effective engagement strategies. Loyal donors, however, display relatively flat donation levels, highlighting a potential area for growth through enhanced retention efforts. Other segments like "Need Attention" and "About to Lose" show variability, emphasizing the need for targeted re-engagement strategies to stabilize and grow their contributions.

3.2. 3.2. Impact on Donations with 20% Increase in Loyal Donors

Currently Loyal Donors account for only 0.05% of the total donor base (5 donors). In 2023 alone, the 5 donors accounted for 53,865 dollars. Figure 6 visually represents the significant financial benefits ROW could achieve by expanding its loyal donor base by 20%. It compares actual donations from loyal donors over the years with projected donations assuming a 20% increase in this segment.

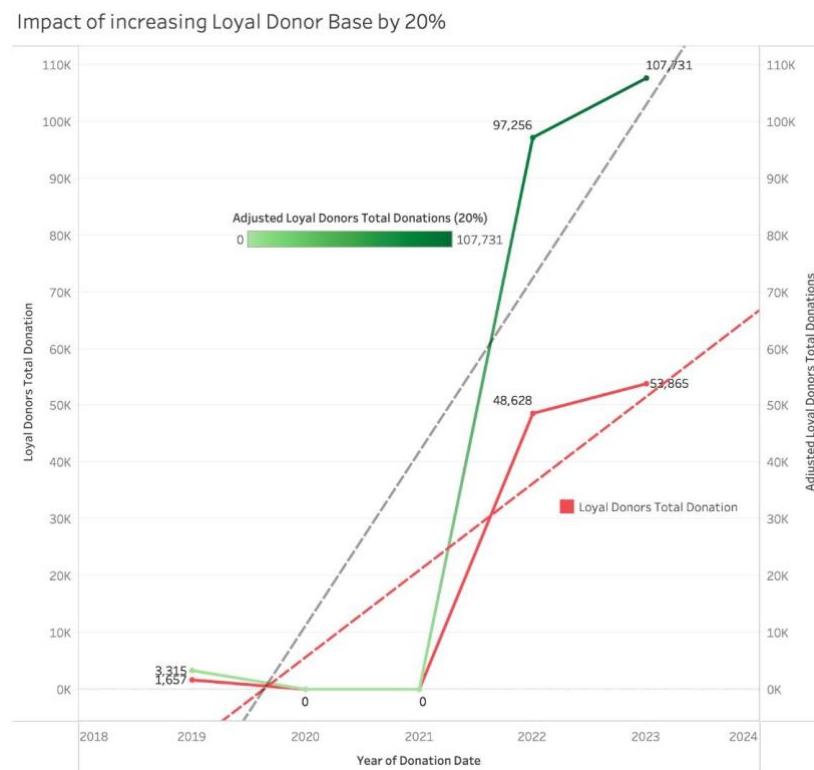


Figure 6: Impact of Increasing Loyal Donor Base by 20%

Key Observations

- **Actual Donations (Red Line):** The actual donations from loyal donors show a noticeable increase over the years, rising from \$3,215 in 2018 to \$52,365 in 2022.
- **Projected Donations with 20% Increase (Green Line):** If the loyal donor base were increased by 20%, projected donations would be substantially higher. For example, in 2021, projected donations would be \$97,256 compared to the actual \$48,628. By 2022, this projection increases to \$107,731, compared to the actual \$52,365.

From 2021 onwards, both actual and projected donations show a steep upward trend, with projected donations nearly doubling the actual figures for 2021 and 2022. A 20% increase in the loyal donor base leads to significantly higher donations each year, highlighting the critical importance of retaining and growing this segment.

What does this suggest in terms of Strategy for ROW?

Overall, investing in loyalty programs and personalised engagement is crucial. Effective donor retention strategies, such as personalized communication and exclusive updates, can convert loyal donors into long-term supporters, significantly boosting donations. At the same time, the increased donations from a larger loyal donor base provide a more stable and sustainable funding stream, essential for long-term planning and ensuring consistent support for ROW's global health initiatives.

4. Donor Deep Dive

4.1. Donor Behaviour

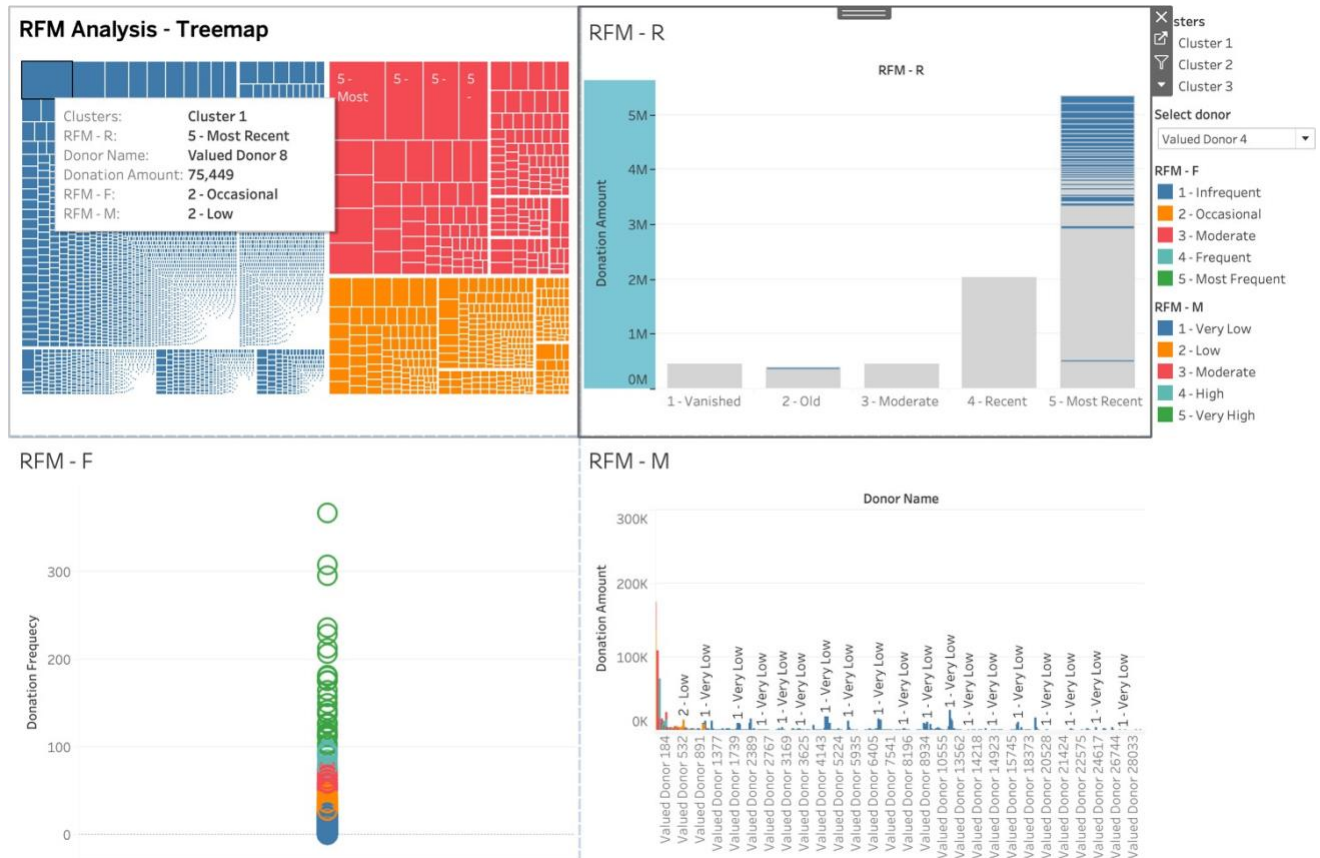


Figure 7: Overall Individual Donor RFM

The provided visualization uses the RFM (Recency, Frequency, Monetary) model to analyse donor behaviour, offering valuable insights for strategic fundraising and donor management. Here's a concise breakdown:

- **RFM Analysis - Treemap:** Donors are clustered by RFM scores; red indicates highly valuable donors with recent, frequent, and large contributions.
- **RFM - R (Recency) Bar Chart:** Shows donation recency, with "Recent" and "Most Recent" highlighting active donors, indicating successful engagement.
- **RFM - F (Frequency) and M (Monetary) Analysis:** Identifies frequent and high-contributing donors, essential for pinpointing key supporters.

- Donor Segmentation and Clustering: Utilizes color-coded clusters to categorize donor behaviors, crucial for tailored communication and personalized appeals.

Overall, the visualization aids in:

- Identifying key donor segments based on their recent activity, frequency of donations, and the monetary value of their contributions.
- Guiding targeted strategies for donor engagement based on individual RFM profiles.
- Evaluating the effectiveness of current fundraising strategies and pinpointing areas for improvement to maximize donor value and engagement.

Strategic Implications:

- Targeted Engagement: Prioritize retention strategies for recent, frequent, and high-value donors.
- Campaign Adjustments: Use insights from recency data to refine ongoing campaigns, aiming to re-engage fewer active donors.
- Resource Allocation: Focus efforts on maintaining relationships with the most valuable donor segments to maximize fundraising efficiency.

From the provided visualization focusing on RFM (Recency, Frequency, Monetary) analysis, here are the insights we can derive about donor behaviour and the specific examples are

4.1.1. Valued Donor 4

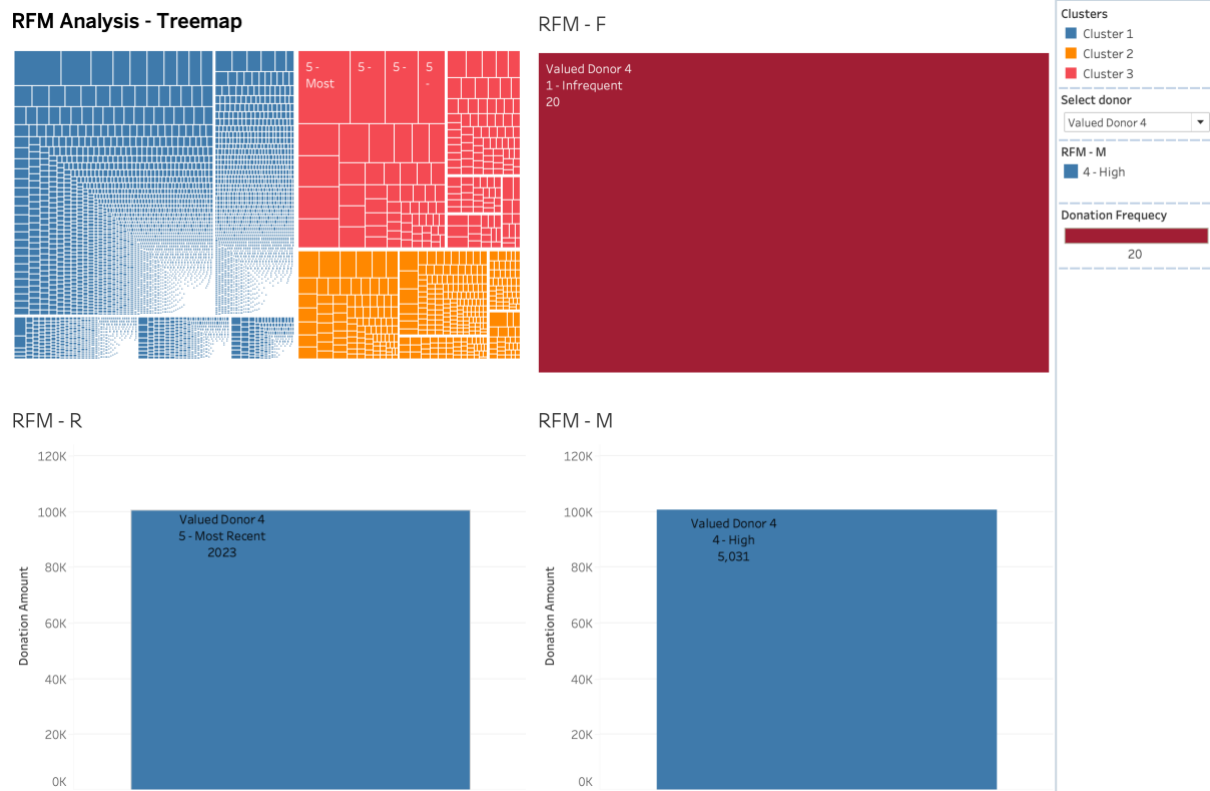


Figure 8: Focusing on Valued Donor 4

Valued Donor 4 is categorized as "1 - Infrequent" with 20 donations, yet they are "5 - Most Recent" with a 2023 contribution and have a "4 - High" monetary score, donating \$5,031. Despite their infrequency, the recency and size of donations suggest significant engagement potential.

Strategic Insights:

- Prioritization of Donor Engagement: Engage Valued Donor 4 more deeply due to their recent, substantial contributions despite infrequent giving.
- Tailored Communication: Customize communications to acknowledge their recent support and encourage more frequent contributions.

- Potential for Upgrade: Leverage Donor 4's recent and high-value donations to motivate them towards more regular giving.

4.1.2. Valued Donor 11196

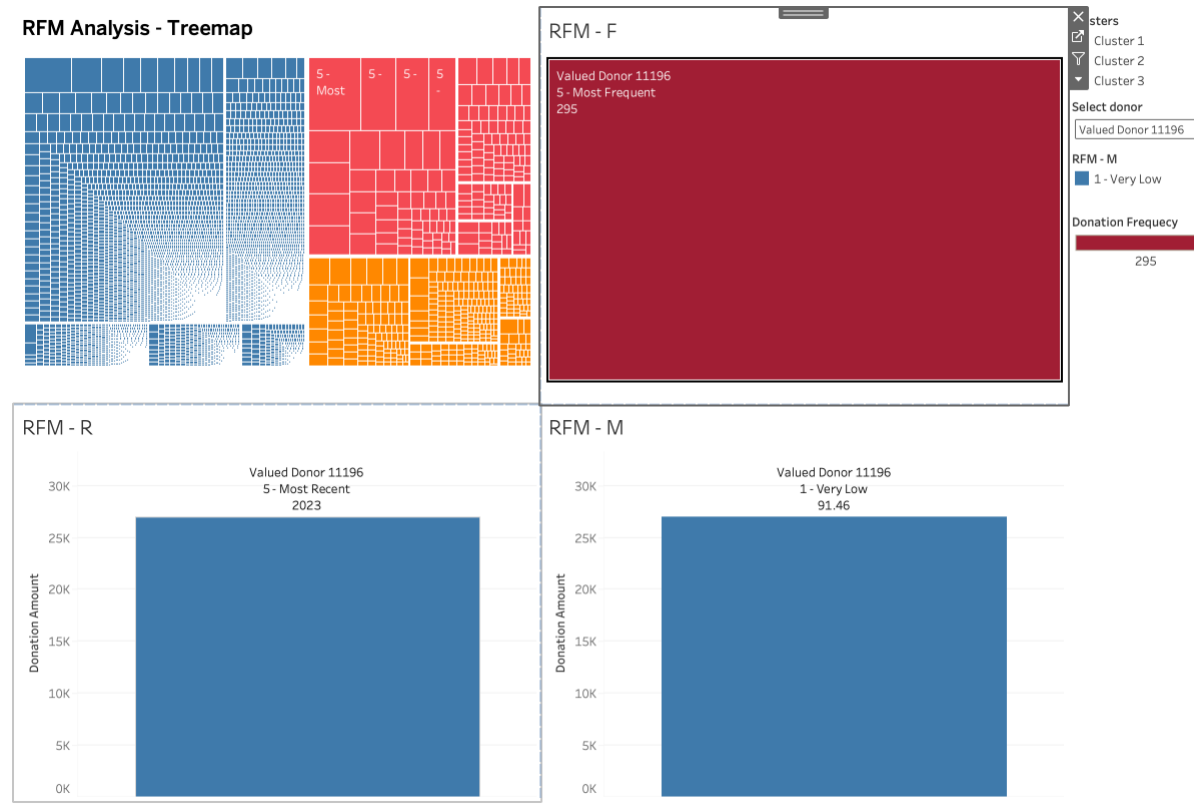


Figure 9: Focusing on Valued Donor 11196

"Valued Donor 11196" shows high engagement, categorized as "5 - Most Recent" for recency with a donation in 2023, and "5 - Most Frequent" with 295 donations, indicating strong commitment. However, their monetary contribution is low, with a total of only \$91.46, reflecting minimal donation amounts despite frequent activity.

Strategic Insights:

- Engagement vs. Contribution Discretion: Frequent but small donations may indicate a preference for regular, modest giving.
- Potential for Upselling: Leverage the donor's frequent interactions to promote higher-value contributions through impact storytelling and matching gifts.
- Personalized Communication: Personalized messages that recognize frequent support and encourage increased donations.
- Donor Recognition: Implement recognition programs to honor consistent support, enhancing loyalty and inspiring larger donations.

4.2. Various aspects of average individual donation amounts

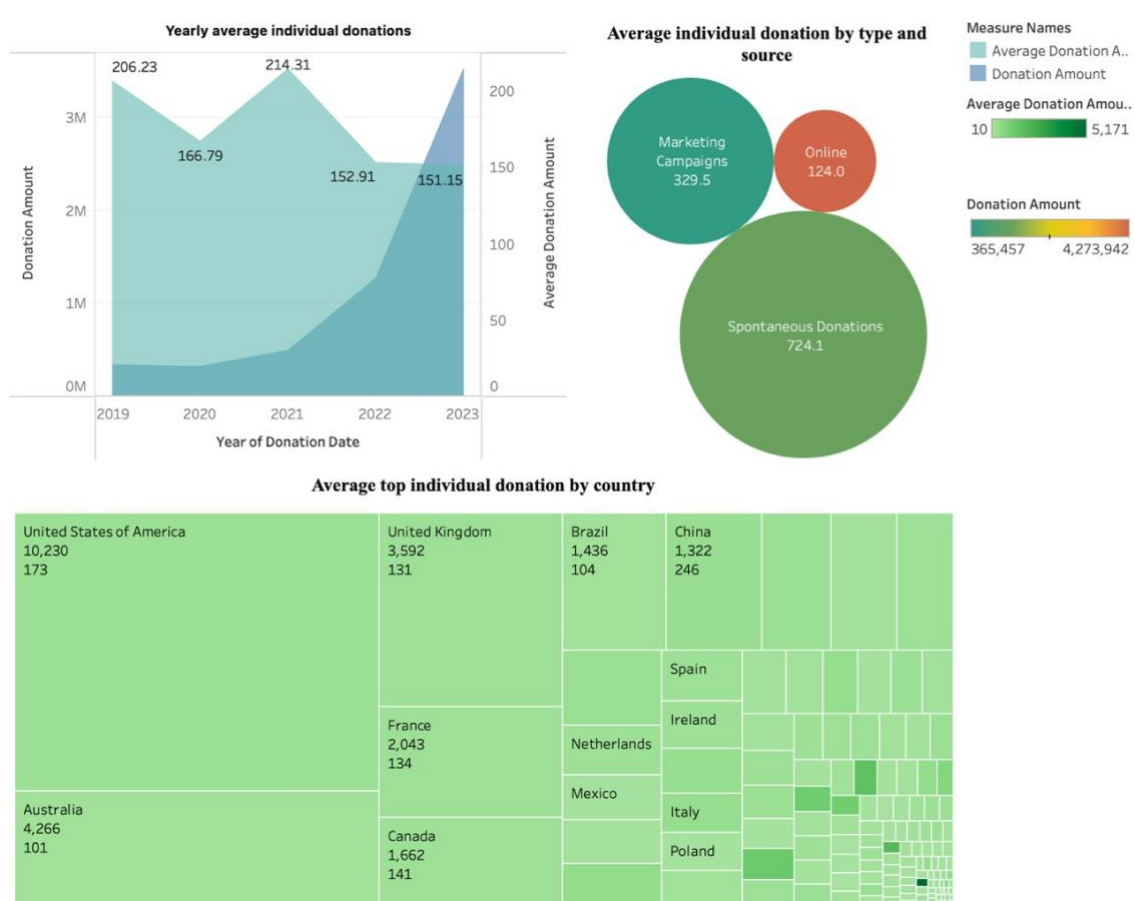


Figure 10: Aspects of Individual Donation

- Average Donation Amounts Over Time:

The graph shows fluctuating average donation amounts from 2019 to 2023, with a notable increase to \$47.52 in 2020 during the COVID-19 pandemic, peaking at \$214.31 in 2021, and a slight decline thereafter.

- Average Amount Relative to Donation Source:

The visualization compares donation sources, showing spontaneous donations average \$724.1, the highest, while marketing campaigns average \$329.5, and online donations the lowest at \$124.0, suggesting varied effectiveness and donor behavior.

- Average Donation Amount by Country:

The treemap shows average donations by country: the US leads in volume with moderate donations averaging \$173, Australia has fewer but larger donations averaging \$101, and smaller countries like Ireland and Poland have fewer, smaller donations but are still significant.

Strategic Implications:

- Resource Allocation: Prioritize resources towards spontaneous donations for better returns.
- Geographical Focus: Increase efforts in high-value areas like Australia and improve engagement in the US, where there are many donors but smaller average donations.
- Campaign Optimization: Use insights to enhance marketing strategies, particularly boosting online donations through targeted digital campaigns.

5. Appeal Deep Dive

Given the multitude of appeals we manage, it is crucial to dig deeper into the specifics. Appeals are the cornerstone of our success, as they are the entities through which we receive donations from across the globe. By focusing on individual appeals, we aim to identify which ones are performing exceptionally well. This targeted approach will help us prioritise appeals that demonstrate strong performance and high donor engagement, ensuring that our efforts are focused on the most impactful areas.

5.1. Affinity Analysis of Appeals

We conducted an affinity analysis to understand how different appeals interact and to identify patterns of donor behaviour. This analysis is crucial for uncovering how certain appeals can influence donations to other appeals. By understanding these connections, we can optimise our strategies to leverage appeals that drive the most engagement.



Figure 11: Revealing Donor Pattern and Behavior

Our findings revealed that some appeals tend to attract donors who are also likely to donate to other specific appeals. Based on the affinity analysis, we categorised appeals into five distinct groups:

Affinity Group	Criteria
Excellent Affinity	Donors frequently donate to this appeal along with several others.
High Affinity	Donors often donate to this appeal and a few others.
Moderate Affinity	Donors sometimes donate to this appeal and one or two others.
Low Affinity	Donors rarely donate to this appeal and another one.
Poor Affinity	Donors almost never donate to this appeal along with any other.

This categorisation helps us to strategically focus on appeals with higher affinity, maximizing our impact and improving donor retention and engagement.

5.2. Appeal 2 - A Catalyst for Donor Engagement

This shared donor base highlights the powerful influence of Appeal 2 in driving multi-appeal engagement and maximizing our fundraising efforts.

Overall Donation Volume

11492

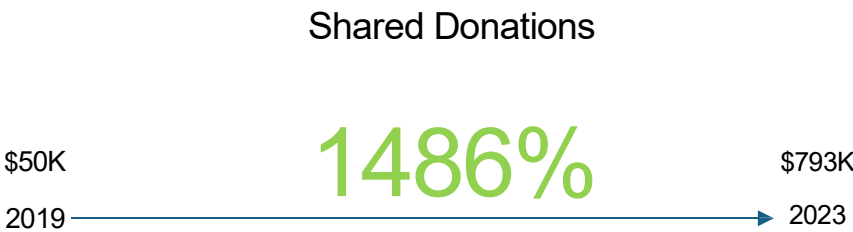
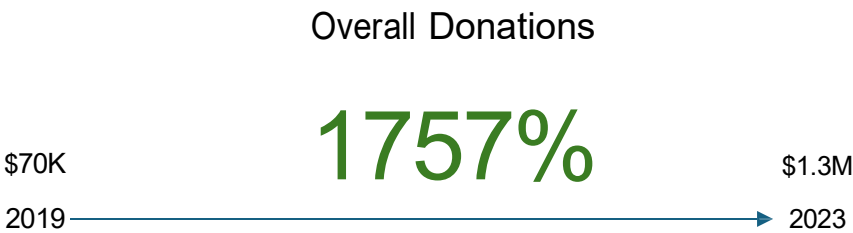
Shared Donations

9521

Replicating the success of Appeal 2 is paramount because it not only maximizes our fundraising efforts but also aligns with the interests and preferences of our donor base. By capitalizing on the patterns identified through our affinity analysis, we can strategically engage donors and amplify the impact of our appeals.

5.3. Appeal 2 Running Performance

After conducting a thorough analysis of several appeals, we identified Appeal 2 as a standout performer. This appeal has consistently demonstrated exceptional year-over-year performance and remains at the forefront of our fundraising efforts.



5.4. Appeal 2 Donor Types

The donor base for Appeal 2 is predominantly composed of individual donors.

99% Individual Donors \$1.2M

Individual donors have contributed significantly, with approximately 9,000 donations out of a total of 9,512. With the widespread availability of online channels, Individual donors find them easily accessible, facilitating their contributions to Appeal 2 and other interconnected appeals. This preference for online channels may be attributed to the convenience and efficiency they offer, enabling individuals to support causes they believe in with just a few clicks.

5.5. Top Individual Donors of Appeal 2

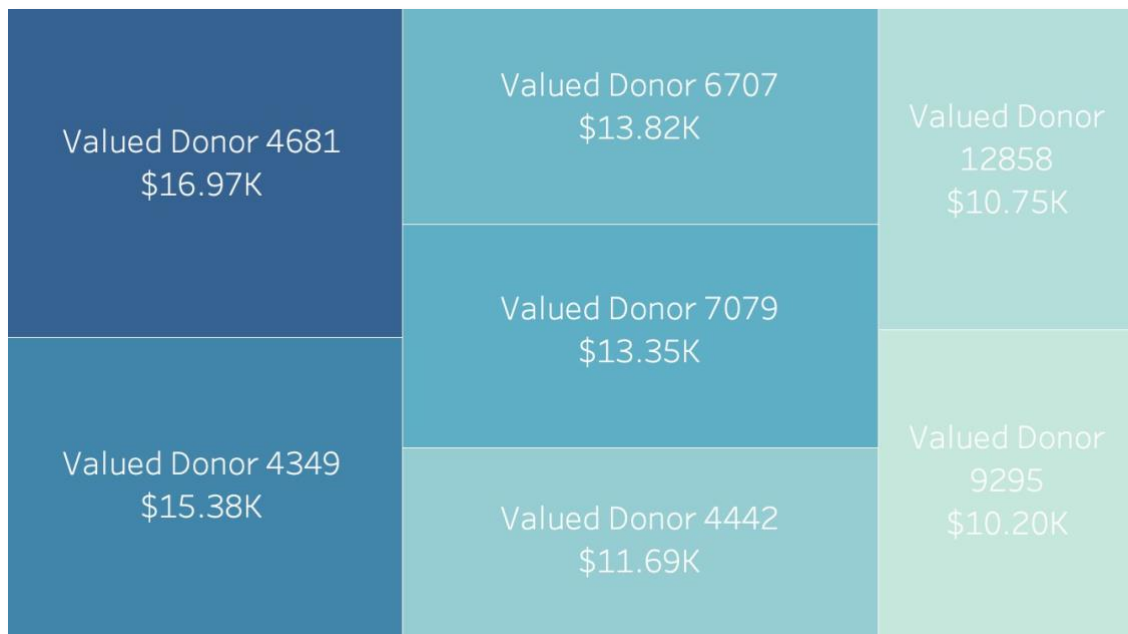


Figure 12: Top Crossover Donor Base - Appeal 2

These donors have donated more than \$10K to Appeal 2 and various other connected Appeals.

5.6. Donor Demography

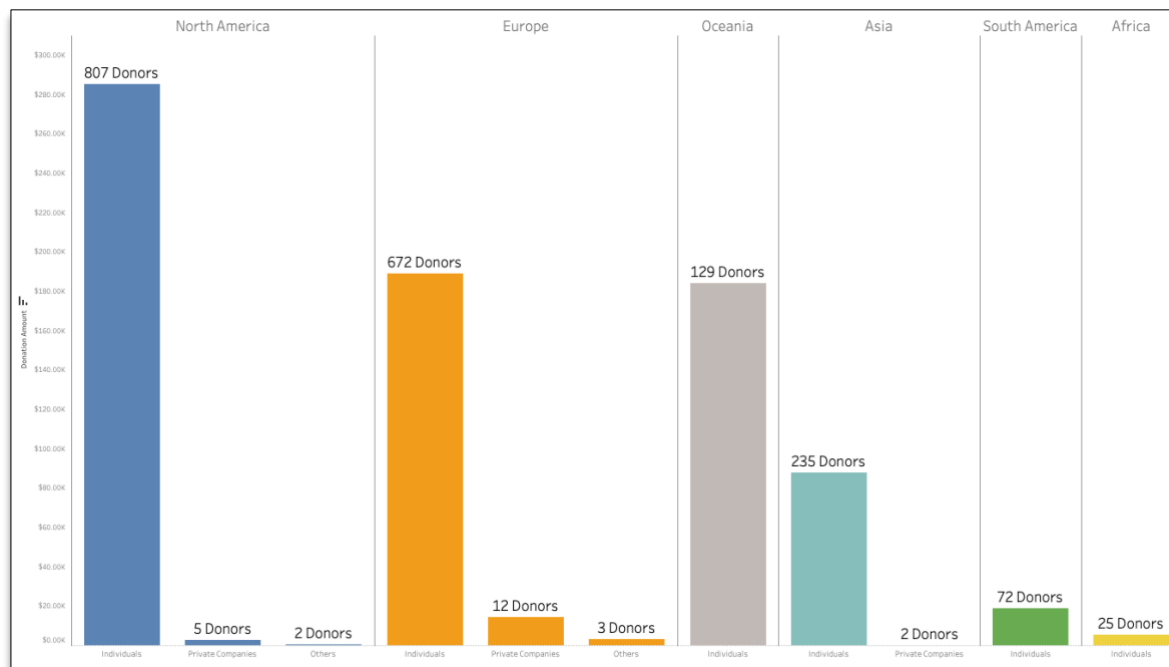


Figure 13: Excellent Affinity of Appeal Donor Types by Countries

A relatively small number of individual donors have made significant contributions to Appeal 2's total funds and are part of the Excellent Affinity group. With approximately 1,500 individual donors collectively contributing \$793,000 since the inception of Appeal 2 until 2023, it shows the substantial impact of these dedicated supporters in driving the fundraising success of Appeal 2 when bundled with similar appeals.

5.7. Top Donor Countries

The donor demography highlights the United States, Australia, and the United Kingdom as primary contributors to Appeal 2, with significant support for other appeals. Individual donors from these countries have shown robust engagement, with donations experiencing a notable spike since 2022. Despite potential inflation fluctuations, their donating power is expected to remain strong, sustaining generous support for Appeal 2 and its bundled appeals.

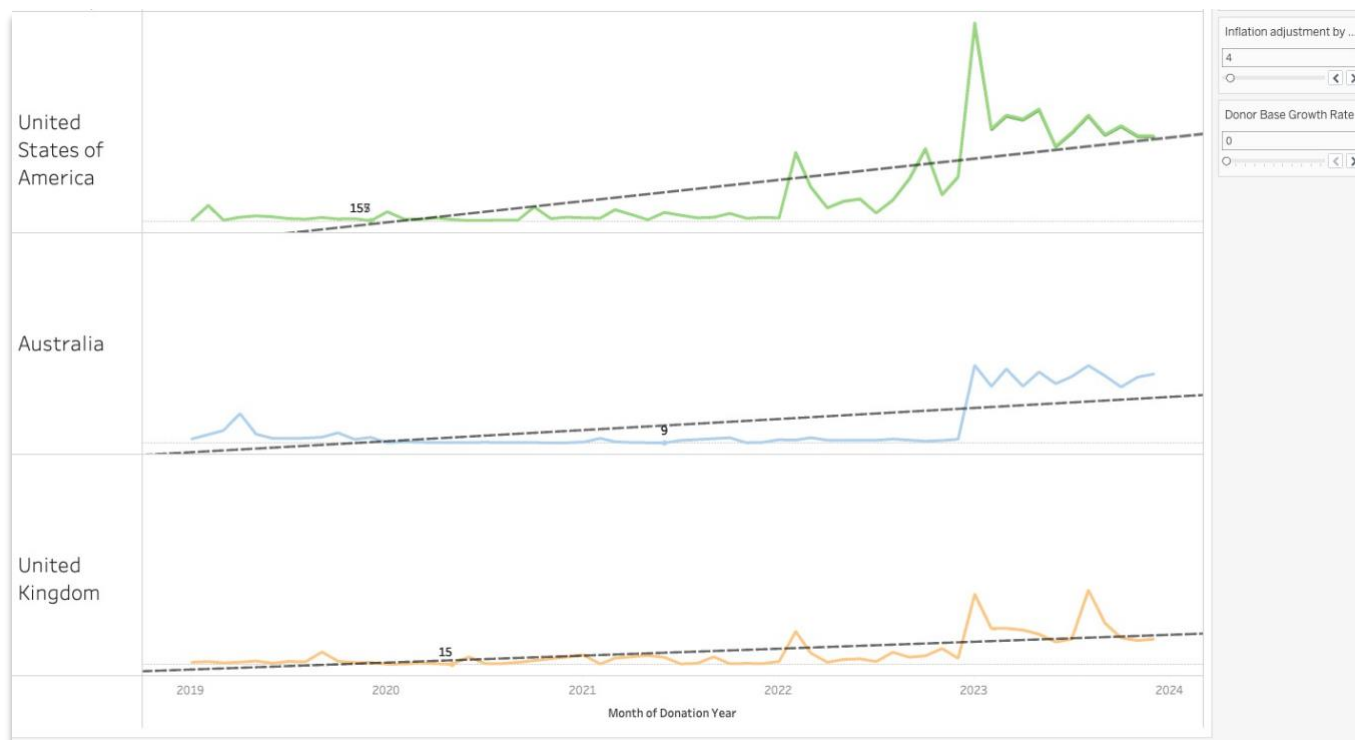


Figure 14: Trend by Top Countries

To leverage this momentum, we recommend a close examination of post-2022 initiatives, particularly those implemented in early 2022, to identify factors driving increased donor engagement. This proactive analysis will inform future strategies, optimizing fundraising efforts for sustained donor support across Appeal 2 and associated appeals.

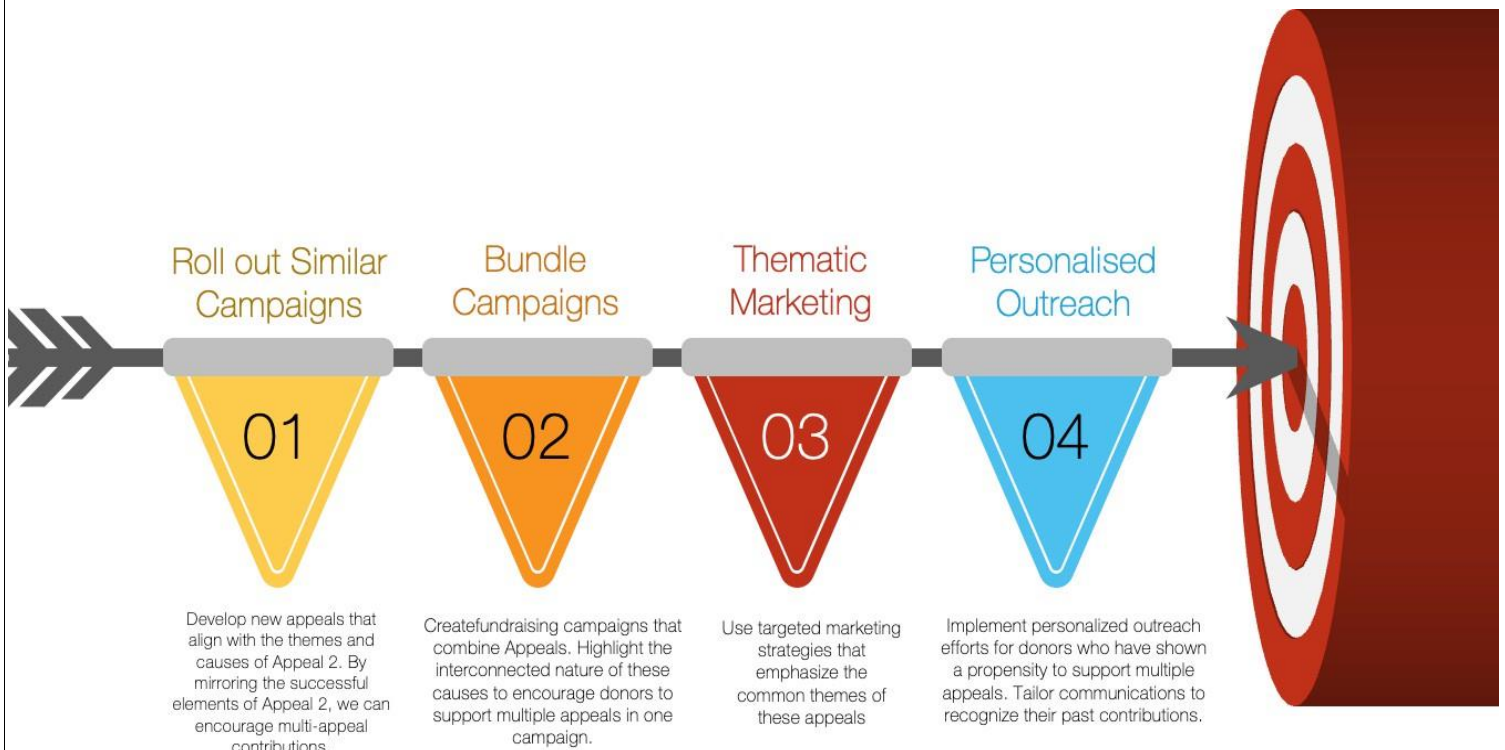
5.8. Strategy for Appeals with Excellent Affinity

Taking Appeal 2 as a model, we have analyzed key factors such as affinity patterns, donor demographics, online engagement, and geographic distribution to develop a comprehensive strategy applicable to all appeals. Given the low rate of inflation in countries where Appeal 2 has high affinity, what if we target individual donors through online channels and offer them appeals with similar sentimental significance? This hypothetical scenario

suggests that such a strategy could enhance donor engagement and retention by leveraging emotional connections and convenience.

By synthesising these insights, we have crafted a unified strategy aimed at maximizing donor engagement and fundraising impact across all appeals. This strategy leverages the unique characteristics of each appeal, tailoring outreach efforts, enhancing online donation platforms, and optimising communication strategies to align with the preferences and behaviors of each appeal's donor base.

By adopting a cohesive approach informed by Appeal 2's success factors, we aim to drive sustained support and impact for all appeals within our organization.



6. Recommendations

To maximise the impact of fundraising efforts, it is recommended that ROW adopt a series of strategies based on advanced data analysis. Firstly, personalise marketing campaigns by segmenting donors according to geolocation, donor types, donation sources, and individual preferences. This will enable the design of specific campaigns for each segment, increasing the effectiveness of communications and donor engagement. Secondly, employ RFM (Recency, Frequency, Monetary Value) analysis to segment donors and enhance personalised communication and social media engagement (Kohavi, R. & Parekn, R. (2004). Additionally, offering flexible payment options that cater to donor preferences will strengthen relationships and long-term loyalty.

The identification of patterns and behaviours through exposed data should be complemented with qualitative methods and an analysis of the external context for a deeper understanding, enabling more effective donor management and retention strategies. Focusing strategies on high-affinity appeals will optimise donor engagement and future growth. Leveraging geographic factors, such as tax laws that provide benefits for charitable donations, ROW can tailor its targeting efforts, improving efficiency in resource management and facilitating the identification of at-risk donors. These actions, aligned with the characteristics of each segment, will not only increase loyalty but also provide valuable insights into donation trends and the impact of implemented strategies, informing future decisions and maximising the impact of ROW's global health initiatives.

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Appendix

RFM Score Breakdown

RFM Profile - R	RFM Profile - F	RFM Profile - M	RFM Profile - RFM	Donor Segments	Distinct cou..
1	1	1	111	Lost	346
2	1	1	211	About to lose	486
3	1	1	311	About to lose	801
		2	312	About to lose	1
4	1	1	411	Need Attention	2,802
	2	1	421	Need Attention	1
5	1	1	511	New Donors	4,991
		2	512	Promising	13
		3	513	Promising	6
		4	514	Promising	3
		5	515	Promising	1
	2	1	521	Promising	28
	3	1	531	Promising	10
	4	1	541	Loyal Donors	2
	5	1	551	Loyal Donors	3

Appendix A: Grouped Donor Segments and their individual RFM Score